

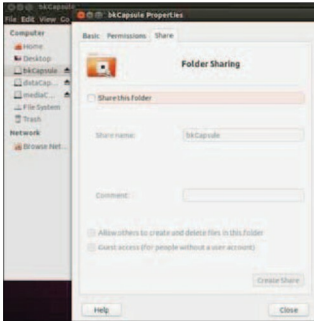


Figure 1: Sharing options

- A PC/laptop with a minimum of 512 MB of RAM and a 1 GHz processor, and a minimum of 5 GB free space for your server. It is recommended that you set up your server close to your router, so you can use a wired (Ethernet) connection instead of Wi-Fi—that is much faster.
- An Ubuntu live CD, downloaded from the Ubuntu website. We will be using the Desktop version rather than the Server version, since it's easier to configure and set up. You could alternately burn the image to a USB flash drive as well, if your soon-to-be server machine does not have a CD drive. Links to help you do this are given at the end of the article.
- Hard drives to store your media/back-ups. You don't need to get new hard disks for this; we will be sharing the content on your existing disks. You could always plug in more storage if you plan on buying new hard disks.

Setting up Ubuntu

Before beginning the installation, make sure you back up any existing data on your soon-to-be server, and that you have at least 5 GB of free space. To begin, insert the CD/USB flash drive into your server machine and boot it up. If your machine is not set to boot from a CD/USB, you may need to press F12 to enter a one-time boot menu and select CD/USB, or you could change the boot device priority in the BIOS settings (but make sure you change it back, if you're going to be using external disks for storage—which is the likely scenario, if you are using an old laptop for your server, like I am). Your system's start-up screen will tell you how to enter the BIOS set-up screen.

After booting into Ubuntu, select the *Install Ubuntu* option and follow the onscreen instructions to set up a dual-boot or

single-boot system, based on your preferences. Also, make sure you select *Log in automatically* when you are creating a user account, so that you have a single-button power-up sequence, which doesn't need any action from you during start-up.

The server set-up

At this point, I assume you have Ubuntu set up successfully and are booted into it. Now for the server set-up: plug in your external drives if you haven't already, and click the Ubuntu Dash (the button with the Ubuntu logo) and search for *Terminal*. Ubuntu has built-in support for NTFS, so your drives should ideally work out-of-the-box. If you are configuring new drives, you can format them as *ext4* for better Linux compatibility. Ubuntu supports HFS-formatted disks (the native format on Macintosh computers) as well, as long as journaling is disabled on them; but for the purposes of this article, let us assume your disks are formatted as NTFS or *ext4*.

Step 1: Mount-points: In the terminal, run the following commands as explained below:

```
sudo mkdir /path/to/mountpoint
sudo chown userName /path/to/mountpoint
```

Replace */path/to/mountpoint* with a folder in which you would like to mount your hard disk. For example:

```
sudo mkdir /media/BackupDisk
sudo chown sumit /media/BackupDisk
```

```
sudo mkdir /media/MovieDisk
sudo chown sumit /media/MovieDisk
```

Enter your password when you are prompted for it. Repeat the commands for each hard disk you have connected to the system.

Step 2: Auto-mounting: Next, run the following command in the terminal:

```
sudo blkid
```

This command should result in an output that looks something like what follows:

```
/dev/sda1: TYPE="ntfs" UUID="A0F0582EF0580CC2"
/dev/sda2: UUID="8c2da865-13f4-47a2-9c92-2f31738469e8" SEC_TYPE="ext2" TYPE="ext3"
/dev/sda3: TYPE="swap" UUID="5641913f-9bbc-4d8a-8bcb-ddfc3159e70f"
/dev/sda5: UUID="FAB008D6B0089AF1" TYPE="ntfs"
```

Basically, what we are trying to do here is to make sure your disks mount automatically every time you boot up your server. The *fstab* or file systems table is a configuration file